

SNIPPETS

Bharti Telesoft is now Comviva Technologies

Bharti Telesoft, a provider of integrated VAS solutions for mobile operators, has changed its name to Comviva Technologies. The move is aimed at creating an independent identity for the company. The name change will be accompanied by a company-wide rebranding initiative to present a unified approach to the market.

Canon launches 23 digicam and camcorder products

Canon India has launched 23 new digital camera and camcorder products. The launch included eight digital compact cameras, ten digital video camcorders, one digital SLR, one compact photo printer and three lenses. In India, 2.5 million digital cameras have been sold till date. Canon India expects its camera division to grow at 30 per cent even in the current global slowdown phase.

Panasonic to develop 3D full HD production system

Panasonic is going to develop a professional 3D Full HD production system. The system will consist of a twin-lens P2 professional camera recorder and a 3D-compatible HD plasma display. With the new 3D production system, which can enable an easier and more efficient 3D production process and environment, Panasonic said it would contribute to accelerating the realisation of easier high-quality 3D content production.

BSNL creates international business unit

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) has created an international business unit to explore telecom opportunities abroad. The PSU had already received approval to enter the bidding for Tunisia, which had issued licences for fixed-line and basic mobile services, initially for 15 years, including national and international long-distance services. M.K. Jain is heading the new business unit at BSNL.

Agilent, DST and CII join hands

Agilent, Department of Science and Technology (DST) and Confederation of India Industry (CII) have signed an MoU for India Innovation Initiative (i3), to jointly transform innovations into major enterprises. i3 aims to create an eco-system in the country that is conducive for growth through innovation by sensitising, encouraging and promoting innovators and facilitating commercialisation of innovations.

i3 also enjoys the support of experts from IIM Ahmedabad who have committed to mentor and incubate the top ten technologies. It is not restricted to schools, colleges, universities, industry or institutes, but is open to all innovators above 18 years, irrespective of their background or profession.

The best of innovations will be promoted to the industry for commercialisation and exploitation for wealth generation. Interested participants can register online at 'www.innovationgrid.org/i3.' The last date for submission of projects is May 30, 2009. The topic for this year is technology in-

novation for masses and global impacts.

Freescal samples 45nm devices

Freescal Semiconductor is accelerating availability of key communication products based on 45nm process technology, in response to strong demand from wireless infrastructure equipment manufacturers targeting advanced 3G and 4G systems.

The company is now sampling the PowerQUICC MPC8569E processor, the dual-core QorIQ P2020 device and the six-core MSC8156 StarCore digital signal processor. The devices are sampling to more than a dozen OEM customers and actively being used in the development of next-generation infrastructure solutions.

LG sells over two million Cookie's

LG Electronics claims its full-touchscreen handset Cookie (KP500) to have recorded over two million unit sales worldwide in the five months since its debut last October despite the global

economic downturn.

According to the company, Cookie allows more people to experience a taste of touch technology at an attractive price, but with advanced features usually found exclusively in premium full-touchscreen handsets.

More than 1.2 million people have had used LG Cookie in Europe, and 600,000 Cookies have been sold in Asia and the emerging markets, including Latin America. In Korea, LG Cookie is currently the most popular handset with 100,000 units in accumulated sales as of March this year and record one-day sales of 4500 units, claims the company.

Toshiba to acquire Panasonic's stake in LCD JV

Toshiba will acquire all of Panasonic's shares in Toshiba Matsushita Display Technology Co., Ltd (TMD) for reportedly \$20.3 million. TMD is a joint venture that develops, manufactures and sells liquid crystal displays (LCDs) and organic light-emitting displays (OLEDs).

Toshiba currently has a 60 per cent stake in TMD. After completion of the share transfer transaction, TMD will become a wholly owned subsidiary of Toshiba Group and change its name to Toshiba Mobile Display Co.

Freescal to close fabs in Japan, France

Freescal Semiconductor is going to close its 150mm fabrication facilities in Sendai (Japan) and Toulouse (France) by 2011. The action resulted from the company's decision to eliminate its 150mm manufacturing capability, in order to remain competitive and maintain an efficient manufacturing footprint.

Freescal is also in the process of winding down manufacturing at its East Kilbride, Scotland, fab now—a closure that was announced several years ago. The actions in Scotland, France and Japan will leave Freescal with three 200mm fabs—one in Phoenix and two in Austin—and two assembly and test facilities in Asia (in Malaysia and China).